PAPER BROS

English Language Practice Workbook

PAPER 2 WRITING · MARK SCHEMES

20 Mark Schemes with Sample Answers

Cambridge O Level English Language 1123 format · Time allowed: 2 hours each

Preview

Prepared by PaperBros

Original practice material in the format of Cambridge O Level English Language 1123. Not an official Cambridge publication.

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Each mark scheme gives the task notes, level tables and a high-scoring sample answer, with marks and an examiner comment, for every question.

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Marking guidance for all papers

General marking principles

1. Award marks for each response in line with the specific content in the mark scheme, the skills defined in the mark scheme or level descriptions, and the standard of response the mark scheme describes.
2. Award whole marks only – never half marks or other fractions.
3. Mark positively. Marks are not deducted for errors or omissions. Credit correct answers that are worded differently from the mark scheme, and valid answers that go beyond it. Spelling, punctuation and grammar are judged only where the question says so, but the meaning of every answer must be clear.
4. Apply the mark scheme consistently, including the rules for responses that do not follow the instructions.
5. Use the full range of marks available.
6. Award marks according to the mark scheme, not with grade boundaries in mind.

Marking with level descriptions

- Level descriptions are a guide to the qualities typical of work in each level. They are not hurdle statements: a response does not have to meet every bullet to be placed in a level.
- Read the whole response, decide which level best fits it overall, then choose a mark within that level.
- Indicative content is not prescriptive. Reward alternative relevant ideas and unexpected approaches fairly, provided they are clearly related to the task and the texts.

Section A: Directed writing (25 marks)

- **Reading (10 marks)** rewards the selection of relevant ideas from **both** texts (R5) and the extent to which they are evaluated and developed (R3). Simply listing ideas from the texts limits a response to the middle levels.
- **Writing (15 marks)** rewards development of content, organisation, sentence range, vocabulary, register appropriate to the form (speech, letter, article, report or email) and accuracy.
- Responses should be written in the candidate's own words. Long stretches copied from the texts should not be rewarded.
- Responses that are well beyond 350 words often lose focus and accuracy; very short responses are unlikely to develop ideas sufficiently.

Section B: Composition (25 marks)

- **Content and structure (10 marks)** rewards the effective use of descriptive or narrative features and deliberate organisation.
- **Style and accuracy (15 marks)** rewards the range and accuracy of sentences, the precision of vocabulary, and accurate spelling, punctuation and grammar.
- Descriptive writing should keep narrative to a minimum; narrative writing should be a coherent story with a clear sense of direction and ending.

Using the sample answers

- Each practice paper is followed by a high-scoring sample answer to every question (Question 1 and all four compositions).
- Every sample is within the recommended word range, is marked against the tables in the mark scheme, and has an examiner-style comment showing exactly which level descriptors it meets.
- Study the approach, structure and techniques – the way texts are evaluated, how paragraphs are linked, how tension or atmosphere is built – rather than memorising wording.

Preview

O Level Practice Paper

ENGLISH LANGUAGE **1123/02**

Paper 2 Writing **Practice Paper 01**

MARK SCHEME AND SAMPLE ANSWERS

Maximum Mark: 50

Practice Mark Scheme

This mark scheme contains the marking guidance for PaperBros Practice Paper 01. It follows the structure, assessment objectives and level descriptors of the Cambridge O Level English Language (1123) Paper 2 Writing syllabus.

Level descriptions are a guide to the qualities typical of work in each level; they are not hurdle statements. Indicative content is not prescriptive: reward alternative relevant ideas and approaches fairly.

A high-scoring sample answer is provided for every question, with marks and an examiner-style comment linked to the level descriptors.

Preview

This document consists of 12 printed pages.

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PREVIEW

Section A: Directed Writing

Question 1

This question tests the following reading assessment objectives (10 marks)

R3 analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text
R5 select and use information for specific purposes.

and the following writing assessment objectives (15 marks)

W1 articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined
W2 organise and structure ideas and opinions for deliberate effect
W3 use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures appropriate to context
W4 use register appropriate to context
W5 make accurate use of spelling, punctuation and grammar.

Question	Answer	Marks
1	**Your school council is discussing whether school uniform should remain compulsory. After reading the two texts, you decide to give a speech at the next school assembly, giving your views on whether students should have to wear a school uniform.** **Write your speech for the school assembly.** **In your speech, you should:** • **evaluate the ideas and opinions in both texts** • **give your own views about whether school uniform should be compulsory, based on what you have read in the texts.** **Base your speech on what you have read in both texts but be careful to use your own words.** **Address both of the bullet points.** **Begin your speech with a suitable greeting.** **Write about 250 to 350 words.** **Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 15 marks for the quality of your writing.**	25

Question	Answer	Marks
1	**Notes on task:** Responses should be based on some or all of the following ideas: **Text 1** Viewpoint – school uniform should not be compulsory • uniforms are expensive / only one supplier / a burden for large families • uncomfortable / impractical in hot weather / affects concentration • crush individuality / creativity / students not trusted to make choices • teachers waste lesson time enforcing rules / detentions • workplaces are more casual / choosing appropriate clothes is a life skill **Max 5** **Text 2** Viewpoint – school uniform benefits students • equality / hides differences in wealth / prevents teasing and competition over brands • makes mornings simpler / saves time / prevents arguments • sense of belonging / pride / shared identity • encourages good behaviour (students represent the school) • safety / students easy to identify on trips / strangers stand out • prepares students for workplace dress codes **Max 5** **Evaluation** is offering a judgement of an idea. Anything which suggests prioritising one idea over another, or dismissing an idea, is valid as evaluation. Phrases which may lead to evaluation include: 'the most important point', 'one of the biggest concerns', 'it is certainly true that', 'I cannot deny', 'it is claimed that', 'this ignores	

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